

Harshul Basava

+1 (408) 355-4218 | harshulbasava7@gmail.com | github.com/harshul-basava | linkedin.com/in/harshulb

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology, Atlanta, GA
B.S. in Computer Science **GPA: 4.0**

Expected Graduation: May, 2028

Relevant Coursework: *Data Structures and Algorithms*

Technical Skills

Languages/Frameworks: Python, Java, C#, PyTorch, HF Transformers, InspectAI, Tinker

ML/AI: RL [PPO, DQL], SFT/LoRA [NLP Classification, Chat Tuning]

Development Tools: Git(Hub), W&B, Jupyter, Colab, Runpod, Claude Code

Experience

Second Look Research

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

Operations Director

- Manage **8 research fellows** replicating AI safety research. Disperse compute, review and approve proposals, contact potential mentors and speakers, provide feedback and hands-on implementation help.

Supervised Program for Alignment Research (SPAR)

Feb 2026 - June 2026

Research Mentee

- **Understanding Generalization through Fine-Tuning** under **Keshav Shenoy** and **Emil Ryd**. Paper accepted to **ICML 2026 Workshop on Foundations of Deep Generative Models**.

AI Safety Initiative @ Georgia Tech

Jan 2026 - Present

Co-Director

- Lead a **team of 6** to manage **speaker event logistics**, coordinate **outreach and marketing**, organize **AI Safety fellowship** and **paper reading group**, and improve **internal organizational efficiency**.

Projects

DS@GT Applied Research Competitions

Jan 2026 - Present

Project Lead / NLP Researcher

- Explored **10+ approaches for AI text detection** (e.g. logistic regression, LightGBM, LLM QA, LoRA fine-tuning) evaluated with ROC-AUC, Brier, F1, C@1, and F0.5u on in-distribution and 5 OOD datasets
- Achieved **0.999 in-dist. and 0.998 OOD ROC-AUC** by fine-tuning **Qwen2.5-1.5B with LoRA and homoglyph/synonym data augmentation** to resist adversarial obfuscation. Placed [4/32 in PAN @ CLEF](#).

MIT BEAVERWORKS – Serious Games with Artificial Intelligence

Jul 2024

Project Manager / Student Researcher

- Led my team in developing a Serious Game to research and compare human and machine performance in statistically ambiguous situations – used **reinforcement learning (PPO)** and agile development practices

Unity Game Development

Oct 2023 - Feb 2025

- Independently published **4 games** using Unity (C#) – **278 App Store downloads, 174 itch.io views**
- Strengthened **OOP and systemic design** fundamentals; utilized on-screen I/O and translated on-device data (**gyroscope/rotation data**) for input; applied design principles to develop **intuitive UI**
- Independently developed a game and published to itch.io in 4 days as a submission to the GMITK Game Jam; **Achieved top 15% of 7,604 submissions (community scored); Top 1,000 in creativity.**

Media Bias Sequence-Classification Model

December 2023 - March 2024

- Independently fine-tuned an **Large Language Model (BERT base uncased)** for multilabel multiclass classification to identify biased reporting regarding the Israel-Palestine conflict; **F1-Score: 71.95%**

AWARDS / HONORS

Dr. Bob Berman Award for Disruptive Engineering - Awarded at Beaver Works; **14 recipients/411 total students**